

Dodékathlos: A Hybrid Board Game

Rulebook & Game Instructions

INTRODUCTION & OVERVIEW

Dodékathlos is a hybrid, cooperative board game for **1 to 5 players** aged **11 and up**. It blends physical components, such as a game board, dice, and cards, with a companion smartphone app that drives the epic narrative.

Players must work together to help Hercules complete his legendary trials. The game features two modes: a **Short Mode** (6 Labors) and a **Full Mode** (12 Labors).

OBJECTIVE

Your goal is to successfully conquer the Labors of Hercules.

- In **Short Mode**, you must claim at least **4 out of 6 Labors** to win.
- In **Full Mode**, you must claim at least **8 out of 12 Labors** to win.

THE HEROES & STATS

Players choose from 5 mythological characters. If playing in **Solitary Mode (1 Player)**, you must play as Hercules. As the player count increases, you can add the remaining companions to your team.

Each character possesses unique ratings (from 1 to 5) across **5 Core Attributes: STRENGTH, DEXTERITY, INTELLIGENCE, WISDOM, CHARISMA**. These points are added to your dice rolls to beat a Labor's Difficulty Class.

Hero	Strength	Dexterity	Intelligence	Wisdom	Charisma
Hercules	5	3	1	2	4
Iolaus	3	5	2	3	2
Athena	2	3	5	4	1
Theseus	4	2	2	2	5
Hermes	1	4	4	1	5

GAME COMPONENTS (BOX KIT)

- **1 GAME BOARD:** Featuring a historical map of ancient Greece showcasing the geographic locations of the 12 Labors. Around the board there are the illustrations of the 12 labors acting as a "Checklist Track" to monitor your conquests.

- **5 HERO CARDS:** Double-sided cards showing the character's artwork and stats on the front, and their mythological biography on the back.
- **5 CHARACTER PAWNS:** Placed on the board over the specific Labor currently being attempted.
- **2 SIX-SIDED DICE (2d6):** Standard dice rolled during challenges. On one of the dice, the number 1 is replaced by a **Lightning Bolt** symbol.
- **PERIL & AID DECK:** Whenever a player rolls a Lightning Bolt, they must draw a card from this deck. It contains four card types:
 1. **Zeus's Aid:** Adds bonus points to your current roll.
 2. **Time Bonus:** Grants extra Hourglasses.
 3. **Hera's Interference:** Adds extra points to the Labor's target difficulty.
 4. **Time Deduction:** Discards Hourglasses from your pool.
- **VICTORY & DEFEAT TOKENS:** Coin tokens (Gold for Victory, Black for Defeat) to track completed Labors on the board.
- **COMPANION APP:** Downloadable smartphone application featuring **Nike** as the main voice narrator.

TIME & THE HOURGLASS MECHANIC

Time is managed inside the app via **Hourglasses**.

- **Starting Pool:** 12 Hourglasses in Short Mode / 26 Hourglasses in Full Mode.
- **The Cost of a Labor:** Simply entering and attempting a Labor automatically costs 1 Hourglass.
- **Retries:** If you fail a roll, you can pay 1 Hourglass to retry immediately. You can attempt a Labor a maximum of 3 times (totaling 3 Hourglasses spent) before being forced to retreat.

THE GAMEPLAY LOOP

1. The Setup & Intro

Download the app, select your Game Mode, and input the number of players. **Nike** will introduce the myth.

2. Resolving a Labor

For each Labor, the App states the target **CD (Difficulty Class)** and the 3 **Attributes** required.

The designated player pays 1 Hourglass and rolls the dice.

VICTORY SCENARIO

If your total score (dice + core attributes) is greater or equal than the labor's class difficulty, tap "Victory" in the app. Nike explains how the hero won, displaying an image of the actual metope from the **Archaeological Museum of Olympia**. Place a **Gold Coin** on the board and move to the next Labor.

DEFEAT SCENARIO

If you fail 3 times (having paid 2 extra Hourglasses), the Labor is lost. Tap "Defeat", place a **Black Coin**, and move forward (provided you can still meet the minimum win condition).

DIFFICULTY CLASSES (CD) & LABORS

Required Attributes Per Labor

- **Nemean Lion:** Strength + Dexterity + Charisma
- **Lernean Hydra:** Intelligence + Dexterity + Strength
- **Ceryneian Hind:** Dexterity + Wisdom + Charisma (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Erymanthian Boar:** Strength + Dexterity + Wisdom (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Augean Stables:** Intelligence + Wisdom + Strength
- **Stymphalian Birds:** Dexterity + Intelligence + Charisma (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Cretan Bull:** Strength + Dexterity + Charisma
- **Mares of Diomedes:** Strength + Wisdom + Charisma (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Belt of Hippolyta:** Charisma + Intelligence + Dexterity
- **Cattle of Geryon:** Strength + Wisdom + Dexterity (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Apples of the Hesperides:** Intelligence + Wisdom + Charisma (*Full Mode Only*)
- **Cerberus:** Strength + Wisdom + Charisma

Short Mode (6 Labors)

- **1 Player (Solo):** Lion: CD 15 - Hydra: CD 16 - Stables: 16 - Bull: CD 17 - Belt: CD 18 - Cerberus: 19
- **2 Players:** Lion: CD 15 (P1) - Hydra: CD 15 (P2) - Stables: CD 16 (P1) - Bull: CD 16 (P2) - Belt: CD 28 (Cooperative) - Cerberus: CD 30 (Cooperative)
- **3 Players:** Lion: CD 15 (P1) - Hydra: CD 15 (P2) - Stables: CD 16 (P3) - Bull: CD 38 (Trio) - Belt: CD 40 (Trio) - Cerberus: CD 42 (Trio)
- **4 Players:** Lion: CD 26 (Pair A) - Hydra: CD 26 (Pair B) - Stables: CD 28 (Pair C) - Bull: CD 28 (Pair D) - Belt: CD 52 (All 4) - Cerberus: CD 55 (All 4)
- **5 Players:** Lion: CD 26 (Hercules+Athena) - Hydra: CD 26 (Hermes+Iolaus) - Stables: CD 28 (Theseus+Hercules) - Bull: CD 28 (Athena+Hermes) - Belt: CD 30 (Iolaus+Theseus) - Cerberus: CD 65 (All 5)

Full Mode (12 Labors)

- **1 Player:** Labors 1–4: CD 15 - Labors 5–8: CD 17 - Labors 9–11: CD 19 - Labor 12: CD 21
- **2 Players:** Labors 1–6 (Alternating Solo): CD 16 - Labors 7–12 (in pair): CD 28

- **3 Players:** Labors 1–6 (Alternating Solo): CD 16 - Labors 7–12 (Co-op Trio): CD 40
- **4 Players:** Labors 1–6 (Alternating Pairs): CD 27 - Labors 7–12 (Co-op All 4): CD 52
- **5 Players:** Labors 1–5 (Solo Turn: Hercules, Iolaus, Athena, Theseus, Hermes): CD 16 - Labor 6 (Hercules+Athena): CD 28 - Labor 7 (Hermes+Iolaus): CD 28 - Labor 8 (Theseus+Hercules): CD 29 - Labor 9 (Athena+Hermes): CD 29 - Labor 10 (Iolaus+Theseus): CD 30 - Labors 11–12 (All 5 Together): CD 65

MUSEUM INTEGRATION & NEW GAME+ PERKS

At the end of the game, victory or defeat, Nike delivers a special announcement: **the adventure continues in the real world!**

If players visit the **Archaeological Museum of Olympia**, they will find special QR codes. Scanning these codes permanently unlocks **Special Perks** on their physical character cards to be used in all future playthroughs at home:

HERCULES: Lion's Hide

Once per game, Hercules can completely ignore one drawn Hera's Interference Card.

IOLAUS: The Faithful Charioteer

In any Solo or Pair challenge featuring Iolaus, the target CD of the Labor is permanently reduced by 2 points.

ATHENA: Owl's Gaze

While Athena is in play, before a player rolls, she can look at the top card of the Peril/Aid deck. If it is a Hera card, she can place it at the bottom of the deck.

THESEUS: Peace Treaty

Once per game, if a roll fails by 3 points or fewer, Theseus can use his Charisma to immediately convert the failure into a victory, saving precious time.

HERMES: Winged Sandals

Once per game, Hermes can use his divine speed to instantly restore 2 Hourglasses to the app's time pool.